

ITU-T

ICT Accessibility for ALL

Meeting with **Mr. Dhaoui**,
Officer-in-Charge Business, Investment
and Technology Services Branch
& **Ms. Haidara**, Director,
Special Programmes and LDC Group
UNIDO

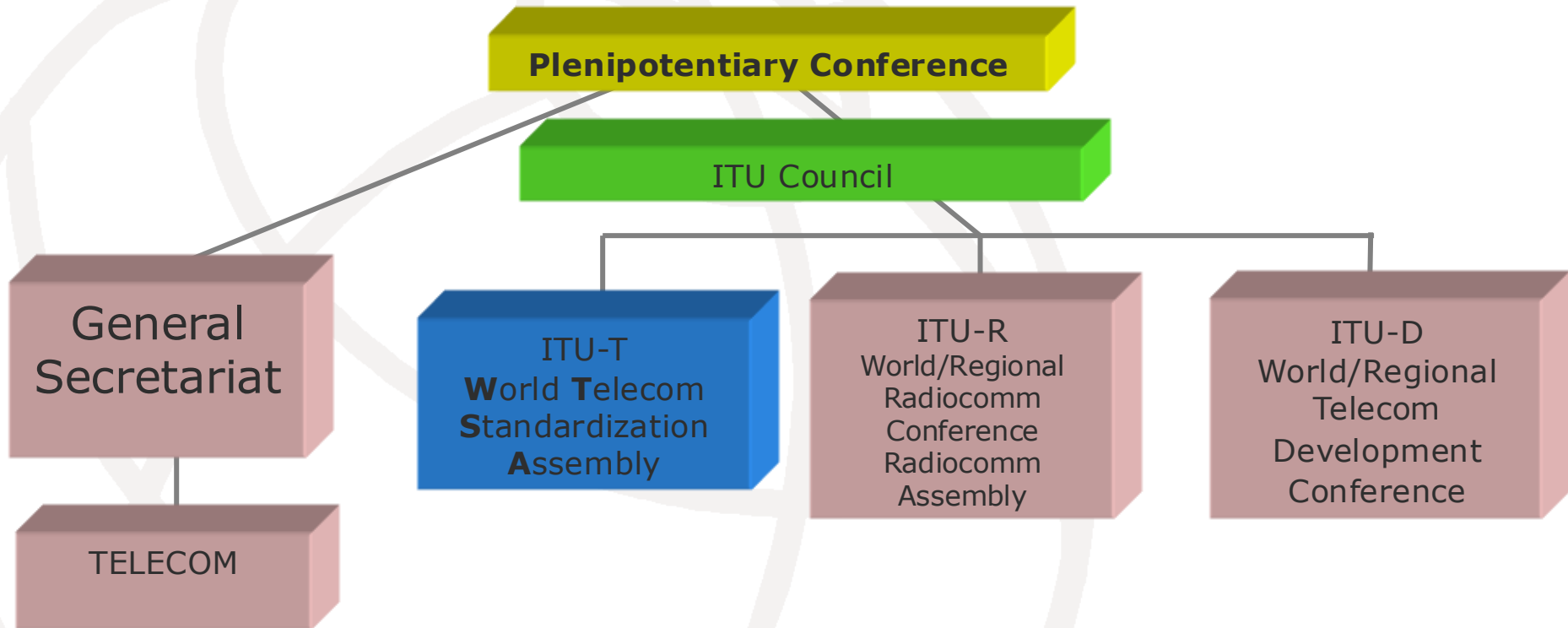
Introduction to ITU

- Founded in 1865, oldest specialized agency of the UN
- Standards making one of the ITU's first activities
- 191 Member States, 780 private sector entities
- HQ Geneva, 11 regional offices, 760 staff / 80 nationalities
- Named as one of the world's ten most enduring institutions by Booz Allen
- Five elected officials:
 - Secretary-General
 - Deputy Secretary-General
 - Director of the Radiocommunication Bureau (BR)
 - Director of the Telecommunication Standardization Bureau (TSB)
 - Director of the Telecommunication Development Bureau (BDT)

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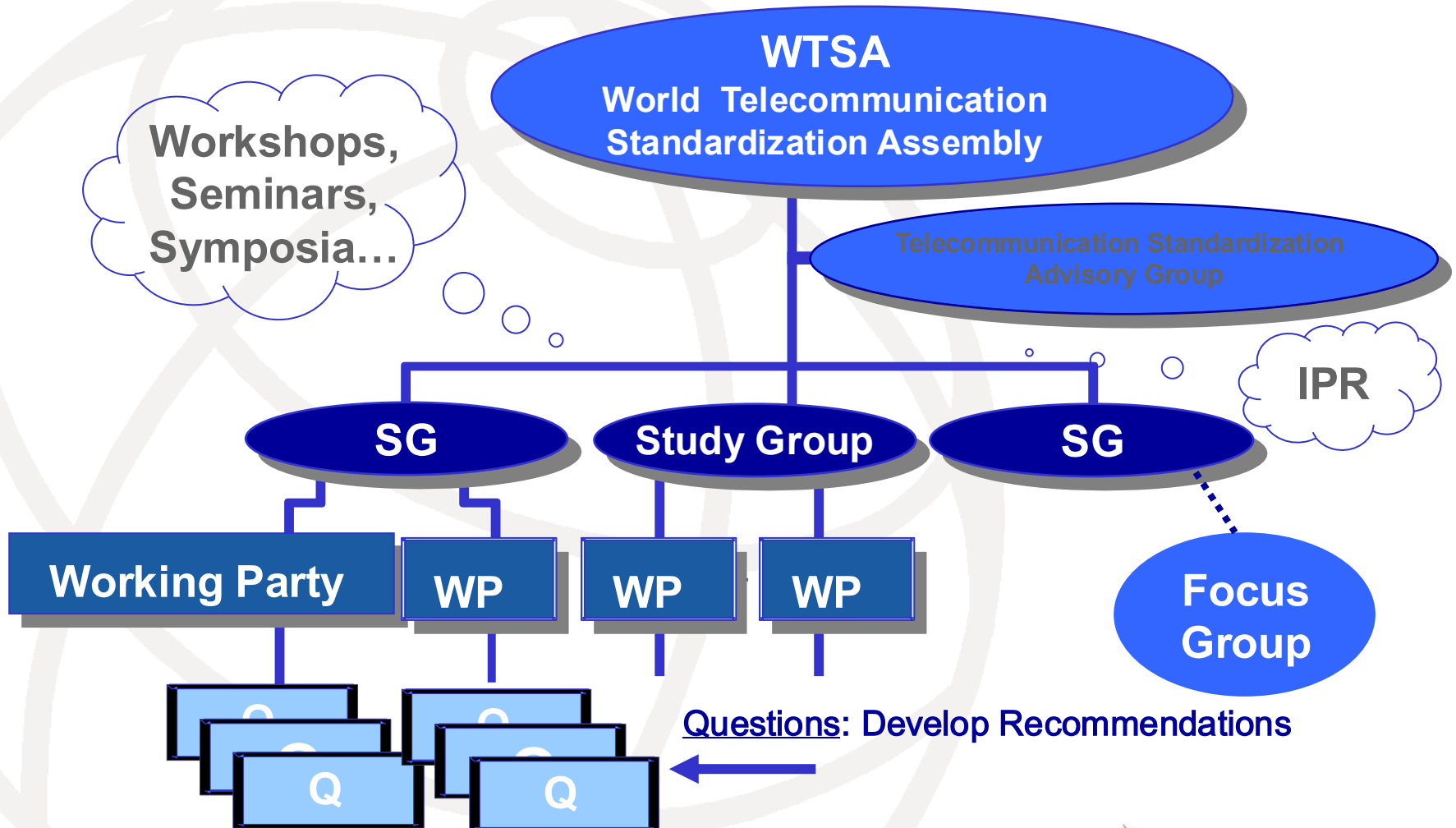


ITU Structure



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ITU-T Structure



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ITU-T Recommendations connect the world...

Without ITU-T standards you couldn't make a telephone call from one side of the world to another.

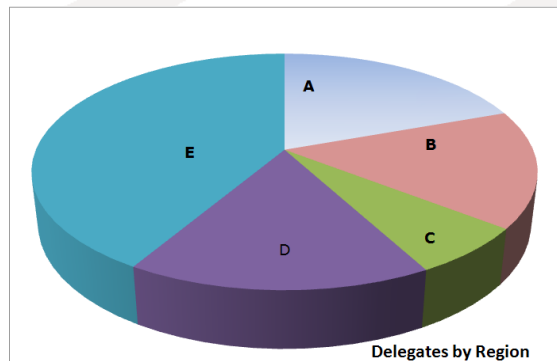
Without ITU-T standards the Internet wouldn't function.



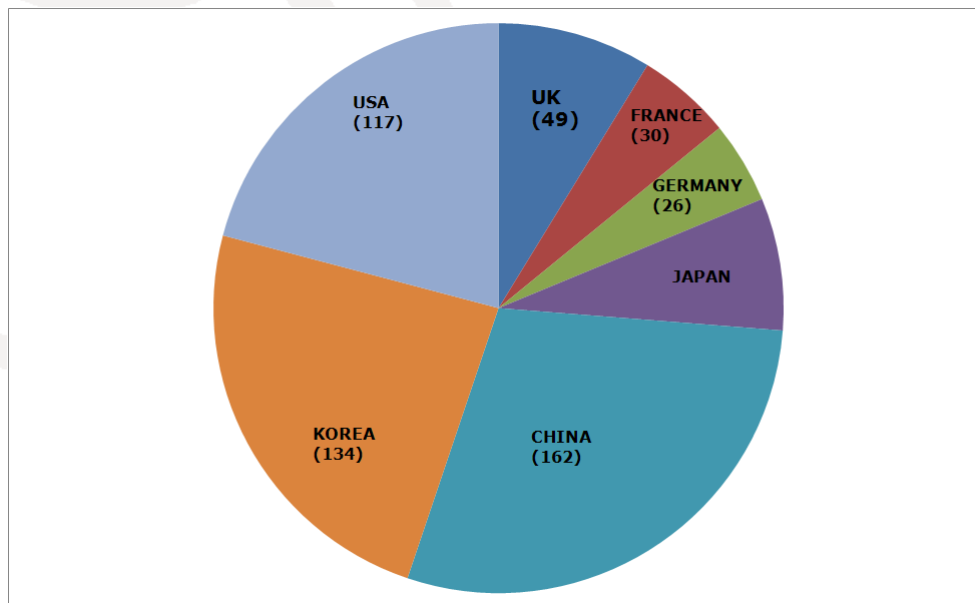
ITU-T Recommendations: Not all standards are equal

- Recommendations become mandatory if adopted in law
- Private standards may confuse users and consumers
- ITU's broad range of stakeholders, and robust processes provide the basis for consensus across sectors and countries
- Market-driven international standards, based on objective information and knowledge
- Meet the needs and concerns of all relevant stakeholders

Member State Participation



Region A - The Americas (216)
Region B - Western Europe (178)
Region C - Eastern Europe and Northern Asia (73)
Region D - Africa (182)
Region E - Asia and Australasia (460)



Strategic Objectives

1. Develop and publish timely global standards
2. Identify relevant areas for future standardization projects
3. Provide the most attractive forum for standardization in the interest of the membership
4. Promote value of ITU-T to attract increased membership
5. Disseminate information and know-how
6. Cooperate and collaborate with other Sectors and other entities
7. Provide support and assistance to the membership, in particular developing countries

ITU-T Key Features

- Open, transparent, consensus based, fast working, public/private partnership
- Technical standards developed by industry members, when consensus placed on website and if no comments after 4 weeks is in effect approved by 191 governments
- ITU standards are therefore truly global, open standards, unlike those of many other standards bodies, fora or consortium that claim to produce global and open standards, available free of charge
- Publicly available database of products and services meeting ITU standards
- Organizing interoperability events to prove interoperability of different vendors equipment
- Common IPR policy with ISO and IEC (FRAN)



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Importance of Global Standards

- Global Standards essential in a complex world
- Standards make things easier
- Essential for international communications and global trade
- Drive competitiveness, for individual businesses and world economy
- Help organisations with their efficiency, effectiveness, responsiveness and innovation
- Lower prices and increase availability by reducing technical barriers and promoting compatibility between systems and networks
- Manufacturers, network operators and consumers benefit

Standards proven economic tool

- WTO trade report 2005
- British Standards Institute (BSI): standards make annual contribution GBP 2.5 billion
- German standards body (DIN): economic benefits standardization about 1% GDP
- Canada: 17 % of labour productivity increase and nine per cent of growth of GDP 1981-2004
- Standards have a significant effect on limiting the undesirable outcomes of market failure
- The work of ITU has smoothed the more economical introduction of new technologies

ITU-T collaboration

44 formal partnerships



- Vienna Agreement between the international standards orgs and their European regional counterparts
- World Standards Cooperation
 - Patent policy & Joint events
- ITU-T and IEEE
 - MoU & Joint events
- Global Standards Collaboration
 - Supports ITU as preeminent global ICT standards organization
- ITU-T and 3GPP
- ETSI
 - Management meetings
- ITU-T and IETF
 - Management meetings
- ITU-T and ICANN
 - Management meetings
- E-Business MoU: IEC, ISO, ITU and UN/ECE

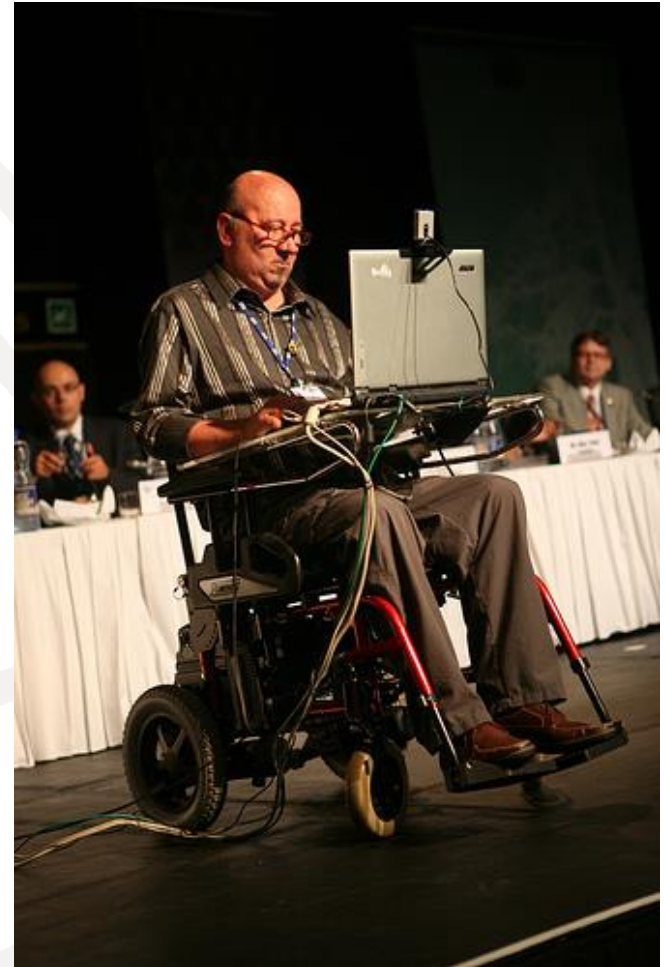
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Accessibility – some facts

- More than 650 million people (=10%) with disabilities in the world (Source: UN)
- 80% of persons with disabilities live in low income countries (Source: UNDP)
- Low income countries, 90% of children with disabilities do not have access to school (Source: UNESCO)
- Among people living below the poverty level, 1 out of 5 is a person with disability (Source: World Bank)
- ICTs are a powerful equalizer of abilities, empowering persons with disabilities to fulfill their potential, dreams and ambitions
- UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities obliges signatories to provide public information in formats appropriate to different kinds of disabilities

ITU and Accessibility

- Champions principles Universal Design enshrined in the UN Convention on Rights of Persons with Disabilities
- Includes accessibility features in all standards
- Strong advocacy focus
- Group to coordinate activities on accessibility
- Dynamic Coalition on the Internet and Accessibility at the Internet Governance Forum (IGF)
- Regular workshops



Why standardization and accessibility

- Information handling capability varies for all ICT users
- Everyone can benefit from accessibility standards
- ITU-T's accessibility work ensures that all newly developed standards contain the necessary elements to make services and features usable for people with as broad range of capabilities as possible
- Standards should also describe suitable methods of media delivery for people with disabilities, and are therefore essential for the provision of services accessible for all

WTSA-08 Resolution on Accessibility

- **Resolution 70** encourages more work in the field of telecommunication/ICT accessibility for persons with disabilities

considering

- That the World Health Organization estimates that ten per cent of the world's population (more than 650 million people) are persons with disabilities, and that this percentage may increase

invites the Director of the Telecommunication Standardization Bureau

- To identify and document examples of best practice for accessibility
- To review the accessibility of ITU-T services and facilities
- To work collaboratively on accessibility-related activities with ITU-D, in particular developing programmes that enable developing countries to introduce services that allow persons with disabilities to utilize telecommunication services effectively
- To work collaboratively and cooperatively with other standardization organizations and entities... in the interest of ensuring that ongoing work ... is taken into account, in order to avoid duplication
- To work collaboratively and cooperatively with disability organizations

ITU-T work on accessibility

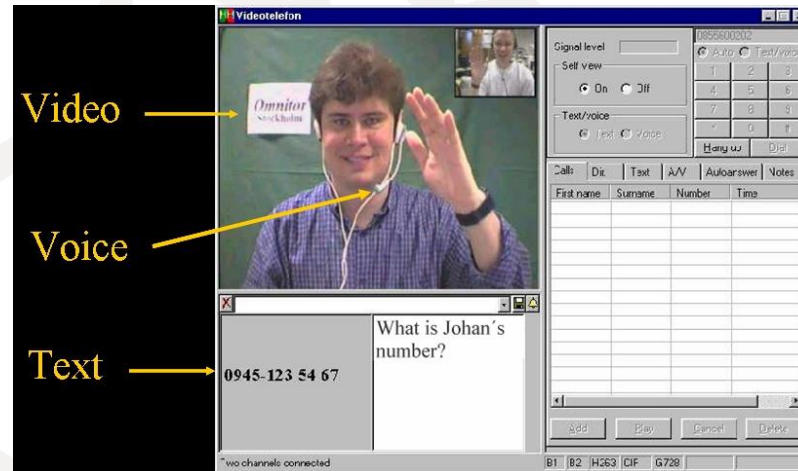
- Joint coordination activity on accessibility and human factors (JCA-AHF) coordinates standardization activities on accessibility and human factors issues
 - Open to experts working in the field to improve access to the information society by people with varied capability of handling information and the controls for its presentation
- Dynamic Coalition on Accessibility and Disabilities, under the Internet Governance Forum
- Global Standards Symposium recognized that accessibility to telecom/ICT services is a major enabler to economic and social development.....in part because a significant percentage of persons with disabilities are poor and live in developing countries
- ITU-T SG16 lead SG on accessibility (Question 26)
- Regular workshops – more than 10 in 2009

Accessibility landmarks

- First international standards body to address accessibility issues - in 1991
- 1994 the international text telephone standard, Recommendation ITU-T V.18, was published
 - A major landmark tying together text telephone protocols allowing different - previously incompatible - textphones in different countries to communicate
- Since then, ITU-T's accessibility experts have helped to incorporate accessibility needs into standards for:
 - Multimedia
 - Network interoperability
 - Multimedia service descriptions
 - Multimedia conferencing
 - Next generation networks (NGN)

Total Conversation

- Rec. ITU-T F.703



- An audiovisual conversation service providing bidirectional symmetric real-time transfer of motion video, text and voice

ITU recognizes dedication to accessibility cause

- All new ITU-T Recommendations will be checked against accessibility criteria
- 2008: World Telecom & Information Society Day
 - Helped raise awareness of the possibilities that ICTs can bring to all.
 - Laureat: Andrea Saks

Andrea Saks



ITU-D Special Initiatives

Promoting ICT Accessibility for Persons with Disabilities

- An Initiative out of WTDC-06 creating awareness and skills to mainstream disability issues.
- Promoting equal ICT opportunities for PwDs.
- Supporting member states meet obligations under Article 9 of the UN Convention for Rights of PwDs.



In addition, ITU-D SG1-Q20, developed Guidelines for ICT accessibility for PwDs & collection of country level statistics on PwDs is in progress



ITU-D/G3ict have developed a toolkit for training policy makers, regulators, other stakeholders: www.e-accessibilitytoolkit.org

- Develop and mainstream ICT policies for PwDs
- Share experiences and best practice

ITU-D also supports ICT projects for PwDs and provides workshops on ICTs issues for PwDs.

Future ITU-D activities

- Capacity building on policies and awareness on ICT accessibility issues via on-line toolkit
 - Training policy makers and stakeholders
 - Platform for best practice and electronic repository of policies on ICT accessibility
- Projects on accessible ICTs in partnership with member states & other stakeholders



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